



The young apprentice

As art and culture flourished in Italy, it became an important gateway between much of Europe and the Far East.

The tremendous trade in silks, spices, and other goods from Asia that passed through Italy was very profitable for the city-states. It made a lot of money for a lot of people.

Some of that money was used to support artists. Wealthy lords and merchants, known as patrons, hired the best painters and sculptors. The most successful and famous artists had

Travelers on trade routes across Asia often moved in large caravans for safety.

